DIY Concrete Woven Texture Planter

Make a Stunning Large Garden Planter Using a Laundry Basket

The secret mold that transfers a beautiful woven texture directly onto concrete — no carving, no stamps needed.

Retail price: $80–$150 • Your cost: under $20

The Laundry Basket Trick

This is one of the most clever concrete hacks you'll ever see. A standard woven laundry basket, lined with plastic, acts as a perfect mold — and transfers its entire woven texture directly onto the concrete surface. The result looks like an expensive hand-crafted planter that could sell for $80–$150 in a garden store. Your total cost? Under $20.

The technique uses two containers — the basket as the outer mold and a smaller bucket pressed into the center to create the planting cavity. Once cured and unmolded, the texture reveal is one of the most satisfying moments in DIY.

What You'll Need

Material	Notes	Cost
Concrete / cement mix (fine or countertop mix)	Quikrete or any fine mix works	~$10–15
Woven laundry basket (round, ~16–20 inches)	The weave pattern = your texture!	~$3–6
Plastic trash bag or sheeting	Lines the inside of the basket	~$1
Smaller plastic bucket or bowl (for inner mold)	Creates the planting hollow	~$2–3
Heavy objects to weigh down inner bucket	Rocks, bricks, filled water bottles	Free
Cooking oil or mold release	Coat inner bucket so it releases cleanly	~$1
Rubber gloves + dust mask	Essential for safe mixing	~$4
Sandpaper (120 grit)	Smooth rough edges after curing	~$2
Concrete sealer (optional)	Protects outdoors, enhances color	~$10
Drainage gravel (handful)	Goes in bottom of planter before soil	~$2

PRO TIP: *The tighter and more defined the weave on your laundry basket, the sharper the texture on your finished planter. Look for baskets with a cross-hatch or herringbone weave pattern — these transfer the most beautifully to concrete.*

Step-by-Step Instructions

Active work time: about 45 minutes. Then 48–72 hours curing. Best done outdoors in mild weather — avoid direct hot sun during curing.

Step 1: Prepare the Basket Mold

Line the inside of your laundry basket completely with a plastic trash bag. Press it into every corner so the concrete doesn't seep through the holes. The plastic also makes unmolding much easier later. Coat your smaller inner bucket generously with cooking oil on the outside.

Step 2: Mix Your Concrete

Mix concrete with water in a separate bucket until you reach a thick, smooth consistency — like heavy peanut butter. No dry lumps. Wear your gloves and dust mask throughout. For a finer surface texture, use countertop or glass-fiber-reinforced mix.

Step 3: Pour the First Layer

Pour a 2-inch layer of concrete into the bottom of the lined basket. Spread it evenly and tamp it down firmly with your gloved hands. This forms the base of your planter. Tap the basket on the ground a few times to release air bubbles from the base layer.

Step 4: Place the Inner Bucket & Build Walls

Press the oiled inner bucket down into the center of the concrete base. Weight it down with rocks or bricks so it doesn't float up. Now pack concrete into the gap between the inner bucket and the basket walls — pressing firmly to ensure it reaches the bottom and fills all gaps. Walls should be 1.5–2 inches thick for durability.

Step 5: Smooth the Top Edge

Use a wet gloved hand or a flat trowel to smooth the top rim of the planter. A clean, even rim makes the finished piece look professional. Wipe any concrete off the outside of the basket immediately.

Step 6: Cure for 48–72 Hours

Cover loosely with plastic wrap or a damp cloth. Keep in a shaded spot — sun and wind cause cracking. Do NOT rush this step. The longer it cures, the stronger and harder the concrete becomes. 72 hours gives you the best result.

Step 7: Unmold — The Magic Moment

Remove the inner bucket first by twisting gently. Then peel away the plastic liner from the outside. Finally, flex and remove the laundry basket — the woven texture will be perfectly transferred onto every centimeter of the planter surface. Sand any rough edges with 120-grit sandpaper.

Step 8: Plant and Display

Add a small handful of gravel to the bottom for drainage before adding soil. Succulents, herbs, or small flowering plants work beautifully in this planter. For outdoor use, apply a concrete sealer to protect against frost and moisture. Place on stones or a stand to allow water drainage from the base.

Plant Pairing Ideas

The woven texture of this planter pairs beautifully with certain plant styles. Here are the combinations that look most stunning:

> ***Succulents (best choice)***
> *Low maintenance, drought tolerant, and their fleshy rosette shapes contrast perfectly against the geometric concrete texture. Echeveria, hens-and-chicks, and sedum are all ideal.*

> ***Ornamental grasses***
> *Tall, flowing grasses create a beautiful contrast against the rigid woven pattern. Blue fescue or Japanese forest grass work particularly well.*

> ***Lavender or herbs***
> *Aromatic herbs like lavender, rosemary, or thyme thrive in the well-draining concrete environment and look stunning spilling over the rim.*

Pro Tips & Troubleshooting

> ***Texture not showing clearly?*** *The basket weave wasn't pressed tight enough against the concrete during pouring. Next time, really pack the concrete firmly into the basket walls, working from bottom to top in layers.*

> ***Concrete cracking after curing?*** *It dried too fast or the mix was too dry. Always cover during curing and keep out of direct sun. Add slightly more water to your next mix — thick peanut butter, not stiff clay.*

> ***Inner bucket won't release?*** *Twist firmly while pulling upward. If still stuck, fill the bucket with warm water — the temperature difference helps release it. The oil coating should prevent bonding.*

> ***Want a darker, richer color?*** *Add a small amount of black or charcoal concrete pigment to your mix. Even a teaspoon changes the color dramatically. Or apply a dark concrete stain after curing.*

> ***Making multiple planters?*** *You can reuse the same laundry basket many times — just replace the plastic liner each time. Make a set of 3 in different sizes for a stunning tiered garden display.*

> ***Winter care outdoors?*** *Apply two coats of concrete sealer before winter. In freeze-thaw climates, bring indoors or into a sheltered area — water expansion in cracks is the main enemy.*

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